What Others Think

Why do we care so much about opinions we don't respect?

READING · TWO SHORT PASSAGES

Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 13: if you want to improve, be content to seem foolish.

Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations* 12.4: we love ourselves more than anyone, yet value others' opinions of us more than our own.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack with the question above and links to both passages.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Ground rules; welcome newcomers	Aloud, together	The questions below	Spot one choice made for show	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Whose opinion of you matters most, and why?
2. Marcus noticed we value others' opinions of us above our own. Is that true for you?
3. When is reputation worth caring about, and when isn't it?
4. What would you do differently if no one would ever know?
5. Epictetus says to be content to seem foolish. Where might that be good advice for you right now?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Reputation as an indifferent. Once a day, notice a choice made for appearances. Ask what you'd choose if no one saw.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"How would you know?" When someone says "everyone thinks…", ask what they actually know.

NOTES